THE PRACTICAL MINI GUIDE

# Your first steps in Germany

Anmeldung, residence rights, health coverage and preparing for work.



**Inside this guide**

Start with the address where you actually live / Prepare the appointment and accommodation confirmation / Handle immigration permission as a separate task

GOOD TO KNOW

## 01 Start with the address where you actually live

Look for the registration service on the official website of your city or municipality. Depending on the location, the office may be called Bürgeramt, Bürgerbüro or Einwohnermeldeamt. The general deadline runs from moving into accommodation, not from signing the rental contract. Check the local instructions and whether your accommodation is handled through a different registration process. A hotel booking, a mailing address and a registered home are not interchangeable.

## 02 Prepare the appointment and accommodation confirmation

Read the document list published by your own registration office before attending. You will normally need an identity document and confirmation from the accommodation provider, commonly called Wohnungsgeberbestätigung. A rental contract is not automatically a substitute for that confirmation. Family registrations may require additional civil-status documents. If an appointment is unavailable, ask the office how to meet your obligation and keep its response rather than assuming a later appointment changes the legal deadline.

GOOD TO KNOW

## 03 Handle immigration permission as a separate task

Your nationality and existing residence document determine which immigration steps apply. EU citizens, people with temporary protection and people entering under other residence routes do not follow an identical process. Ukrainians seeking protection should check the current Germany4Ukraine guidance and the responsible foreigners authority. Registering an address does not by itself establish eligibility for temporary protection. If you already have protection in another country, clarify the consequences before planning a move or changing benefits.

## 04 Confirm insurance and organise the next practical steps

Arrange a health-insurance assessment alongside the administrative appointments. Germany has statutory and private insurance systems; the appropriate route depends on matters such as employment and previous coverage. The registration certificate is not an insurance policy. Ask the responsible insurer or benefits office when your coverage begins and what proof is available. Once the address is confirmed, update relevant contacts and keep appointment confirmations, official correspondence and insurance information somewhere you can find them easily.

GOOD TO KNOW

## 05 Check the exact permission in your documents

Start with your residence document and any additional sheet. EU citizens and people arriving through ordinary third-country employment routes do not have identical requirements. For Ukrainians covered by temporary protection, check the conditions on the residence permit or provisional document, particularly the entry Erwerbstätigkeit erlaubt. Ukrainian nationality alone is not proof of employment permission. If a document is unclear, expired or missing the relevant entry, ask the foreigners authority before accepting a start date.

## 06 Prepare a focused application and check qualifications

Build a CV showing your experience, qualifications, language skills and contact details. Match it to the job rather than sending an identical application for every position. Use the Federal Employment Agency and recognised local advice services to understand the job market. For a regulated profession, professional recognition or authorisation may be necessary before practising. A translated diploma and formal recognition are different things. Ask the relevant recognition advisory service which documents and competent authority apply to your occupation.

# Common questions

### Does Anmeldung allow me to work?

No. Address registration and permission to work are different matters. Check the wording of your residence document and any accompanying conditions. An employer or the foreigners authority can help you identify which evidence is required before employment starts.

### What if I cannot find an appointment within two weeks?

Contact the responsible registration office promptly, follow its instructions and retain your booking attempts and correspondence. Do not assume that a late appointment automatically removes the registration obligation or that another city can register your address.

### Can I register a friend’s address before moving in?

Register the address where you actually take up accommodation and obtain the appropriate accommodation confirmation. If you are staying with someone temporarily, ask the local office which rules apply to that arrangement before submitting your registration.

## Sources and useful links

**Bundesportal — Wohnsitz anmelden**

**Bundesgesundheitsministerium — health insurance**

**Germany4Ukraine — work and support**

The procedure depends on residence documentation, activity and location. The primary sources below help clarify the requirements for your circumstances.

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